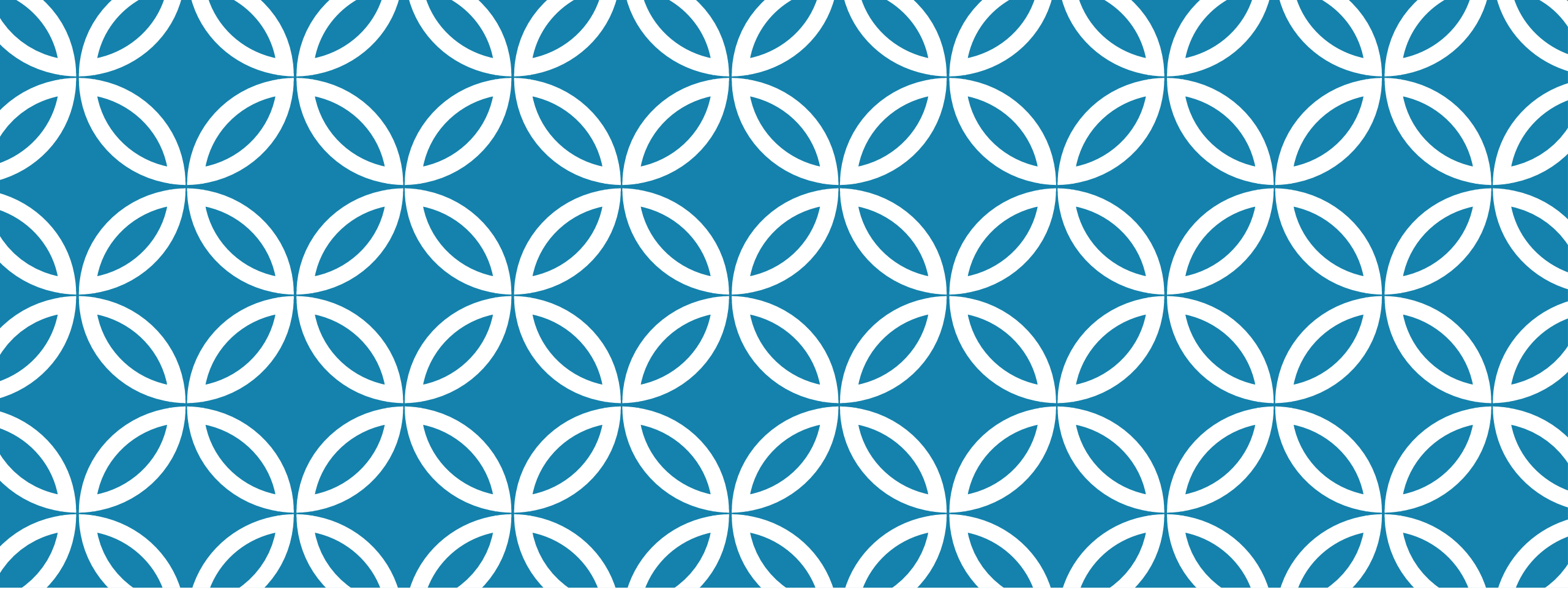




PUBP309: EDUCATION POLICY

Education in Colonial India
1835-1854

Shivakumar Jolad
FLAME University

WILLIAM BENTICK DECISION – 7 MARCH 1835

Concurred largely with Macaulay on English Education.. But kept the Oriental education as it is , without further expansion.

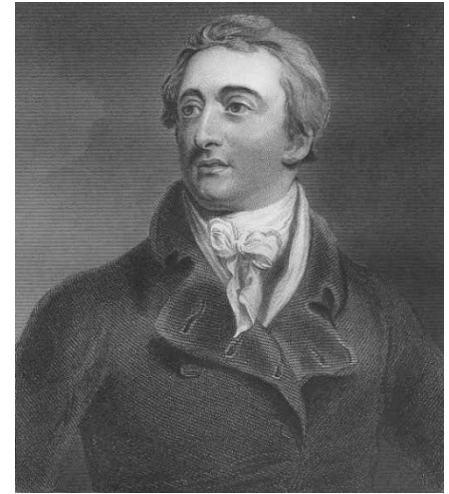
English Education Act 1835

First:... Great object of the British Government ought to be the promotion of European literature and science among the natives of India; and **that all the funds appropriated for the purpose of education would be best employed on English education alone.**

Second, : His Lordship in Council directs that **all the existing professors and students** at all the institutions under the superintendence of the Committee **shall continue to receive their stipends.**

Third, It has come to the knowledge of the Governor-General in Council that a **large sum has been expended by the committee on the printing of Oriental works;** his Lordship in Council directs that no portion of the funds shall hereafter be so employed.

Fourth, His lordship in council directs that all the funds which these



William Bentick
(1774 –1839)

AFTERMATH OF BENTICK'S DECISION

Widespread opposition about exclusive English education

Both Hindus and Muslims opposed it.- Feared Anglicization

Opposition came from some British officers themselves (McNaughten and H T Princep).. They wanted Oriental education support to continue in tandem with English.

Later report of the committee 1835, supported Vernacular education. Its recommendations

- ▮ **The formation of the native literature be the ultimate object to which our efforts must be directed**
- ▮ **Learned foreign tongue would translate English work to reach the masses**

SIGNIFICANCE OF BENTICK'S DECISION

It opened Europe to India- through promotion of Western Education- Literature and Science (SC Ghosh- milestone in the history of India)

Major outcome (unintended consequence):
Promotion of Vernacular Languages and Vernacular Education

BOMBAY AND MADRAS PRESIDENCY

Bengal was given supervisory power over Madras and Bombay by Regulating Act of 1773

Bengal was the chief, It had Governor General .. Bombay and Madras had Governors.

1813-1848.. Edu developments closely followed Bengal.

Education activities: First approval needed from Governor General and then sanctioned by the Court of Directors ..

Had to fit in with the general policy of court of directors.

BOMBAY PRESIDENCY

Peshwas used to give Rs 5,00,000 per annum as **alms** to **Brahmins**

1817 , overthrow of Peshwa at Battle of Kirkee..
Mountstuart Elphinstone, governor from 1819 to 1827.



Mountstuart
Elphinstone
(Pic from wiki)

Poona Sanskrit college established. 1821
(**Deccan College**)

Bombay Education Society (BES) –established 1815 by the church of England for Anglo Indian children education. 1822 extended to native Indians. PRIVATE Body



Special agency: **Bombay Native Education Society** established in 1857
S.C Ghosh, "History of education in modern India: 1757-2012"

ELPHINSTONE'S MINUTE 1823

Suggested improvement of teaching methods, and **encouraged enrollment by lower order of natives**. Establishment of schools of European arts and sciences

Grant in Aid (cooperation between state and private bodies) system was recommended.

Disagreement with Francis Warden (for English education) led to **Anglo-Vernacular controversy**

After Elphinstone retired **people of Bombay set up Rs 2 lakhs for the expanding education...** court of directors gave a matching grant.

S C Ghosh, "History of education in modern India:
1757-2012"

ELPHINSTONE COL

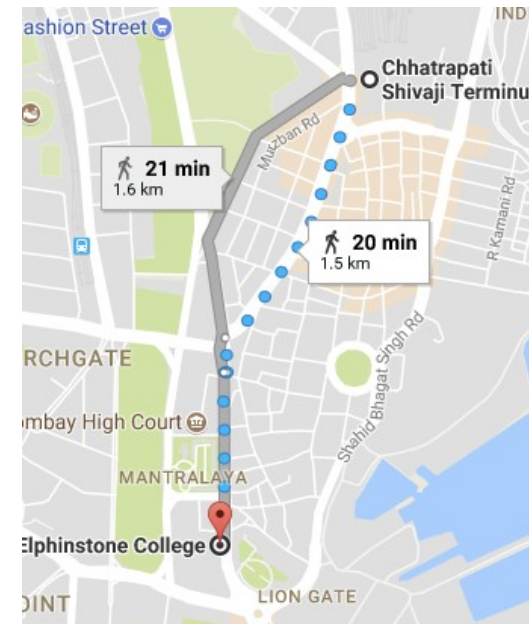
Set up by **Bombay Native Education Society, 1817** in honor of great **Mounstuart Elphinstone**



Elphinstone College

Alumni:

- ▮ **Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Bhim Rao Ambedkar, Jamshedji Tata and Dadabhai Naoroji** (Professor).
- ▮ **Hombi Bhabha, R G Bhandrakar,**
- ▮ **Salman Khan !**



NORTHWESTERN PROVINCE

Agra and Oudh (UP) , Bihar ... Late starter in education reform.

NWP became provincial government in 1843.. Council of Education was transferred to this government.

3 colleges : Agra, Delhi and Benaras- 9 Schools set up by government

The earliest decisions of the Provincial Government **was to educate the people through the medium of their mother-tongue** and not through English.

1845: James Thomson - Lt Governor of NWP .. **Called for special attention to vernacular education..** Appalled by the illiteracy which led to exploitation in land holdings .. Only those who could read and write could avail the benefits of land titles.

JAMES THOMASON PLAN (NORTHWESTERN PROVINCE)

1845: **James Thomson** - Lt Governor of NWP .. **Called for special attention to vernacular education..** Appalled by the illiteracy which led to exploitation in land holdings .. Only those who could read and write could avail the benefits of land titles.

1846 : Stats ... Less than 5% youth had obtained any instruction!

Proposed school in every village .. But was not supported by Court of Directors..

Main ideas of the Thomason Plan:

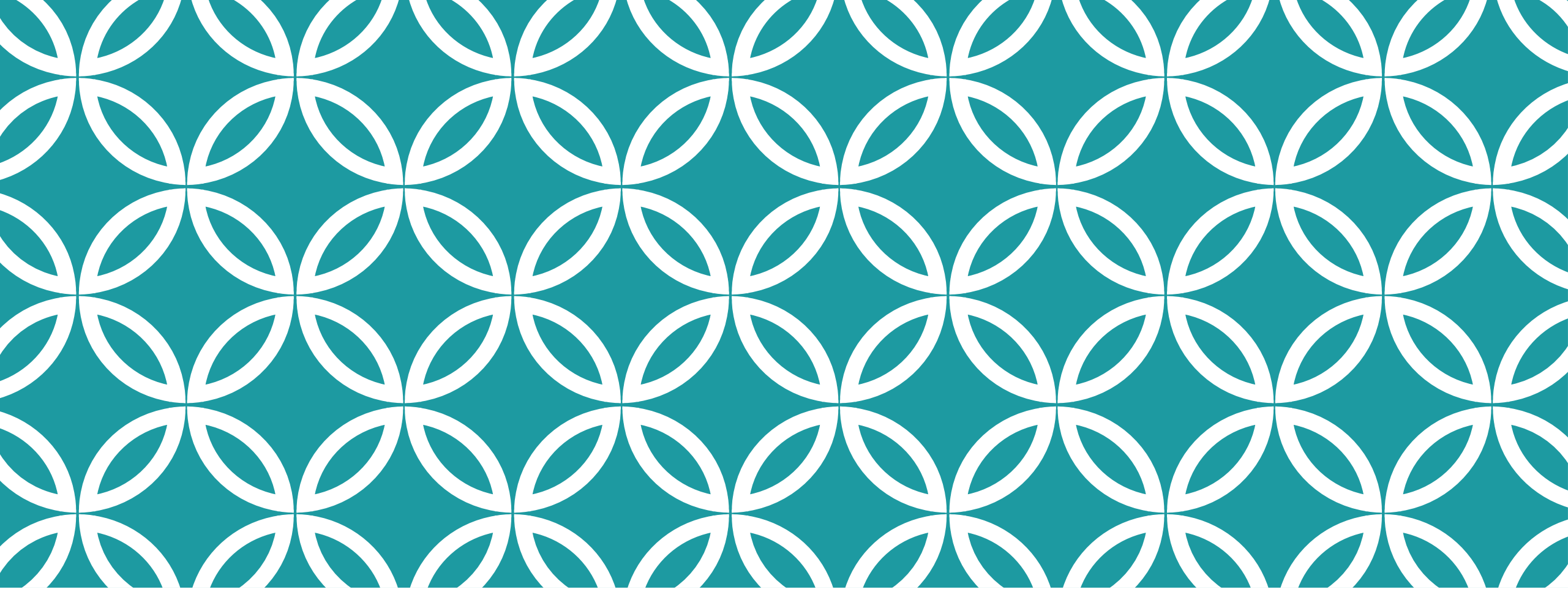
- ▮ **the necessity of incorporating the indigenous schools in a national system of education;**
- ▮ **the creation of an Education Department**
- ▮ **the levy of a local rate for educational purposes.**

Proposed **model school (vernacular language)** in every tahsil.. Initially only in 8 districts this plan was implemented..



James Thomason (1804-1853)

Pic source: wiki



EDUCATION OF WOMEN 1813-1854 |

EDUCATION OF WOMEN- 1820-30

The **almost complete absence** of the education of women in the Indian society of the early nineteenth century .

- ▢ **Bengal**: Adam's census – only 4 women literate (as against 21,907 men) in a total population of 496,974.
- ▢ **Bombay**: no girl pupils attending the indigenous schools were reported either in the enquiry of 1823-25 or in that of 1829 .
- ▢ **Madras**: Situation slightly better. returns of the indigenous schools showed as many as 5,480 girls in a total enrolment of 184,110.
- ▢ Punjab: the existence of **special girls' schools** in charge of women teachers

On the whole, therefore, it may be concluded that barring an extremely small number of women who received some rudimentary education either at home or in schools, general or special, **almost the whole of the female population of the country was deprived of formal education.**

SOCIAL PREJUDICES AGAINST WOMEN

- ▮ **Muslims,:** **evils of purdah and segregation** were the chief obstacles to progress, although women had property rights and a liberal set of marriage and divorce laws
- ▮ **Hindus:** child-marriages were very common; women had very limited property rights and the marriage laws were far too unfavourable to women.
- ▮ **The upper class women suffered from customs such as Sati**, absence of divorce and an enforced asceticism for widows,
- ▮ while among the lower castes, customs like **Devadasis** and **female infanticide** prevailed, to some extent.
- ▮ Over and above all these, there was, among all sections of the male population, a **very strong social prejudice against the education of women.**
- ▮ **Belief among Hindus (especially women) that Girl taught to read and write would become widow after marriage.**
- ▮ Eastern ideal of Female life: Purity, seclusion and quiet domestic duty

JYOTIBA AND SAVITRIBAI PHULE



Jyotirao Phule



Savitribai Phule

Dalit education and Female Education
Satyashodhak Samaj (Society of Seekers of Truth)

School for girls in Ahmednagar

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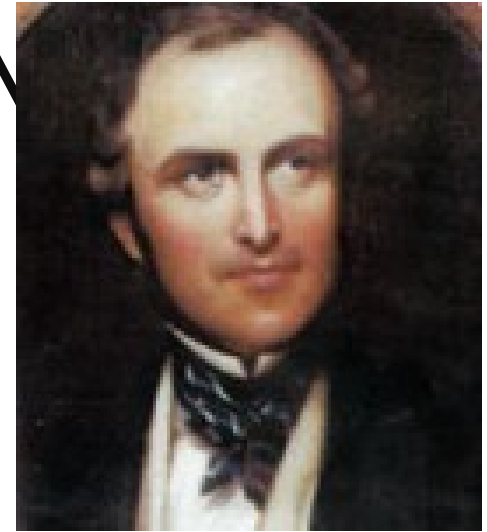
Jyotirao Phule: The Open Well

A portrait of the social reformer and anti-caste campaigner. Professor Sunil Khilnani, from the India Institute, King's College London, visits Pune where Jyotirao Phule set out to educate women and promote the...

Available now
⌚ 15 minutes

FEMALE EDUCATION: BETHUNE CONTRIBUTION

John Elliot Drinkwater **Bethune** - barrister and law member of the Governor-General's council. Pioneer of female education in India. **Set up schools for female students in Calcutta.** Pushed for legislation in this regard



(J E D Bethune 1801 England -1851 Kolkata)

Official support for female education was not existent till then. **None of the official dispatches so far had any reference to female education.**

Missionaries though encouraged female education (**set up schools for girls before, since 1820's**)

Dalhousie: Bethune's work opened the annals of female education in India. ***You have planted a mustard seed which will one day be a great tree, which you and those we serve may be proud to look upon***



Bethune College- Set up 1849, pic from 15 Telegraph

DALHOUSIE CONTRIBUTION TO FEMALE EDUCATION

Dalhousie's council authorized council of Education to supervise and support female education in India.

Dalhousie Instruction 1850:: Use all means at disposition to encourage institutions which support female education

After Bethune's death, Dalhousie and his wife Lady Dalhousie took upon Bethune's female education school in Calcutta with great care.



Lord Dalhousie (1812 – 1860),
Maker of Modern British India

MISSIONARIES AND FEMALE EDUCATION

1821: **Miss Cooke - British Foreign School Society..** opened school for girls in Calcutta

1826- **Ladies Society for female education was formed.**

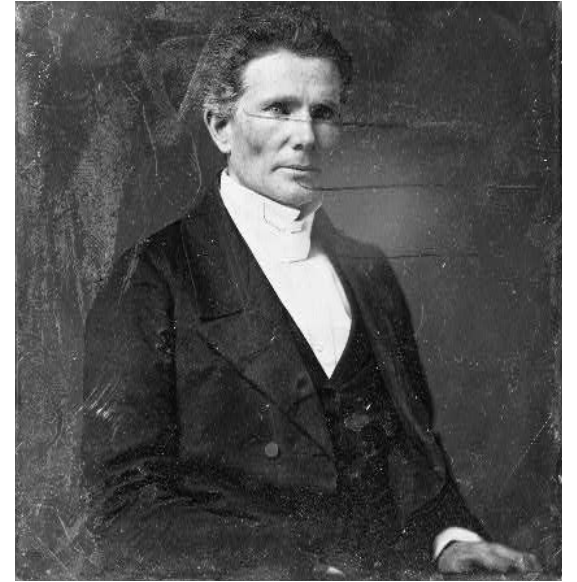
Only in Punjab female education (indigenous) was open to girls – including all communities: Hindus, Muslims and Sikhs . It had female teachers too.

MISSIONARIES 1835 ONWARDS

Alexander Duff – Scottish Missionary in Calcutta.- established **Scottish Church College**. Used English education as means of proselytization

□ **Duff model:** adopted by missionaries in establishing schools and colleges imparting English education.

Missionary schools multiplied since 1830..
Hoped that compulsory reading of bible in schools would induce people (especially upper class) to embrace Christianity later... That never happened!



NON-ENGLISH MISSIONARIES

Chartered Act 1833- allowed other nations missionaries in India

German:

- ▣ **Basel Mission of Berlin (Mangalore, Dharwad)**
- ▣ Protestant Luthern Missionary- Dresden
- ▣ Women's Association of Education of Females – Berlin

American

- ▣ American Baptist Union
- ▣ American Board
- ▣ American Presbyterian Mission

Colleges by Dr. John Wilson in Bombay 1832; General Assembly School Madras; Hilsop College Nagpur, Noble College Mausilpattanam, St John College Agra

GROWTH OF MISSIONARY ENTERPRISE

1830-1857 Age of Mission Schools

Reason for company support

- ▢ Fear of intervening in religious affairs now eroded..
- ▢ Felt no opposition to abolition of Sati
- ▢ Company was now established as an undisputed power in India

Missionary activities most prominent in Madras- as company schools were limited.. 1853: **1500 schools 67000 pupils studying**

Missionary schools (had bible as compulsory subject) were more popular than Company schools. Requested company to withdraw control of schools. They would manage it!

ENLIGHTENED INDIANS

Prejudices against western education: They felt fear of Anglicization and loosing faith in religion.

Indian educated in English :

- ▢ Those who believed English education as agent of modernization
- ▢ **Education as means of passport for better jobs , status and power**

Indians who set schools set it up with the help of Company/European officials.

Followed Hindu school model- Primarily teaching English and English literature. No Religious study.

NOTABLE INDIANS

Raja Ram Mohan Roy

- ▢ Helped set up Hindu School
- ▢ Schools in Surpana, and Simla – Calcutta

Jairam Ghosal: Beneras school in 1818.. English, Persian, Bengali was taught.

Rasik Krishna Mallick: Started Hindu Free school at Simla

Kalinath ray Chaudhuri, Baikunatnath Ray Chauduri also set up schools

General performance of students was really good. British acknowledged the meticulous study of natives.